

Highlights

How much of hazard news is news? Decomposing open-source coverage of chemical accidents and CBRN threats for hazard surveillance

- News volume for 30 hazard queries is decomposed into five labelled components
- Human coders put the CBRN event share at 5%: one article in twenty
- Reference bias reaches 33–89% for rare hazards and 1–2% for matched controls
- Article counts for six chemicals are unrelated to official incident counts
- The gap survives excluding off-topic hits: 14% of on-topic CBRN news is event